

Spirit Full Deity

doc-spirit-full-deity

Pneumatology · Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide
directness direct
variants stable

Statement under examination

The Holy Spirit is fully and truly God, co-equal and co-eternal with the Father and the Son.

In plain language

Two questions sit inside this proposition, and the words answer both. First, is the Spirit God. In Acts 5:3 Peter says Ananias lied to the Holy Spirit ("to lie to the Holy Spirit," ψεύσασθαί τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον), and one verse later, restating the same act, says he did not lie to men but to God ("to God," τῷ θεῷ). One event, two predicates (two descriptive statements about the same act), one addressee. The Spirit is God. Acts 5:9 adds that he tested the Spirit of the Lord ("the Spirit of the Lord," τὸ πνεῦμα κυρίου). In 1 Corinthians 3:16 the believers are God's temple because God's Spirit dwells in them ("the Spirit of God dwells in you," τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ θεοῦ οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν), and 6:19 calls the same body the temple of the Holy Spirit, so Spirit-presence is divine presence. Matthew 28:19 puts Father, Son, and Holy Spirit under one singular name ("name," ὄνομα) in baptism. Hebrews 9:14 calls him the eternal Spirit ("eternal Spirit," πνεύματος αἰωνίου), and Psalm 139:7 says no one can flee from God's Spirit ("spirit," ruach), which is omnipresence (being everywhere at once). Second, is the Spirit a person or just God's power. The word for spirit, pneuma (πνεῦμα), can mean breath or wind and is grammatically neuter, which is why some read it as an impersonal force. But the same texts say the Spirit wills and apportions gifts as he chooses ("wills," βούλεται, 1 Corinthians 12:11), can be grieved ("do not grieve," λυπεῖτε, Ephesians 4:30), speaks and says set apart for me (Acts 13:2), and can be lied to. In John 16:13 the masculine word he ("that one, he," ἐκεῖνος) is used of the neuter noun spirit on purpose. Willing, grieving, speaking, and being lied to are things only a person does, not a force. The evidence runs across the Old Testament and the New, across narrative, gospel, wisdom, and letters, and no manuscript variant at these verses unsettles it. The only room for divergence is the surface ambiguity of one neuter word, which the personal verbs and the God-equation close.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H1272	ברח	barach	to flee	
H7307	רוח	ruach	spirit	378
G0040	ἅγιος	hagios	holy	233
G0166	αἰώνιος	aionios	eternal	70
G0907	βαπτίζω	baptizō	to baptize	
G1014	βούλομαι	boulomai	to plan	37
G1565	ἐκεῖνος	ekeinos	that	243
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,317
G2962	κύριος	kyrios	lord	717

G3076	λυπέω	lypeo	to grieve	26
G3485	ναός	naos	temple	45
G3611	οικέω	oikeo	to dwell	9
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	231
G3962	πατήρ	pater	father	413
G4151	πνεῦμα	pneuma	spirit/breath	379
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	377
G5574	ψεύδομαι	pseudomai	to lie	12

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Two converging lexical lines establish the proposition. First, full deity: Acts 5:3-4 brackets one act with two predicates (two descriptive statements about the same act), lying to the Holy Spirit ("to lie to the Holy Spirit," ψεύσασθαι τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον) is restated as did not lie to men but to God ("you have not lied to men but to God," οὐκ ἐψεύσω ἀνθρώποις ἀλλὰ τῷ θεῷ), a direct grammatical equation that Acts 5:9 extends with "the Spirit of the Lord" (τὸ πνεῦμα κυρίου). Matthew 28:19 places "of the Holy Spirit" (πνεύματος ἁγίου) under one singular "name" (ὄνομα) beside "of the Father" (πατρός) and "of the Son" (υἱοῦ); 1 Corinthians 3:16 grounds "temple of God" (ναὸς θεοῦ) on "the Spirit of God dwells in you" (τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ θεοῦ οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν); Hebrews 9:14 calls it "eternal Spirit" (πνεύματος αἰωνίου), the eternity attribute; and Psalm 139:7 ties the Spirit ("spirit," ruach) to inescapable presence. Second, personhood against an impersonal-force reading: the Spirit wills ("wills," βούλεται, 1 Corinthians 12:11), is grieved ("do not grieve," λυπεῖτε, Ephesians 4:30), and speaks in the first person (Acts 13:2). The pattern is pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) and variant-stable (not disturbed by manuscript differences).

Scripture

Acts.5.3 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G5574 ψεύδομαι, G4151 πνεῦμα, G0040 ἅγιος

Force. Peter charges that Satan filled Ananias's heart to lie to the Holy Spirit. The aorist (a completed past action) infinitive "to lie" (ψεύσασθαι) takes "the Holy Spirit" (τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον) as its direct object. Morphology confirms the Spirit phrase is accusative (the direct-object grammatical form) singular neuter (parsed N-ASN, with the article and adjective also neuter), the grammatical object of an act of deception, which presupposes a personal addressee who can be lied to, not an impersonal influence.

Acts.5.4 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G5574 ψεύδομαι, G2316 θεός

Force. The next clause re-predicates (restates as a description of) the identical act: "you have not lied to men but to God" (οὐκ ἐψεύσω ἀνθρώποις ἀλλὰ τῷ θεῷ). The "not...but" (οὐκ...ἀλλά) contrast frame sets men against God as the two candidate addressees of the single verb "you lied" (ἐψεύσω), and assigns the act to "to God" (τῷ θεῷ). Since the object lied to in verse 3 was the Holy Spirit, the same lie now predicated of God identifies the Spirit with God as one referent. The equation is grammatical, not analogical (a real identity in the grammar, not a loose comparison).

1Cor.3.16 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G3485 ναός, G2316 θεός, G4151 πνεῦμα, G3611 οἰκέω

Force. Paul predicates (asserts as a descriptive statement) "temple of God" (ναὸς θεοῦ) of the believers, then grounds it with "and the Spirit of God dwells in you" (καὶ τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ θεοῦ οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν). The present indicative (ongoing, simple statement of fact) "dwells" (οἰκεῖ, parsed V-PAI-3S) makes the indwelling Spirit the operative reason the locus is God's temple. The temple-making presence is the Spirit's presence, so Spirit-presence functions as divine presence.

Matt.28.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3686 ὄνομα, G3962 πατήρ, G5207 υἱός, G4151 πνεῦμα

Force. "baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit" (βαπτίζοντες αὐτοὺς εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ πατρὸς καὶ τοῦ υἱοῦ καὶ τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος). Morphology confirms "name" (ὄνομα) is one accusative singular noun (parsed N-ASN, direct-object form), governed once, distributed across three articular genitives ("of-X" forms with "the," τοῦ) joined by "and" (καί). The Spirit shares the single baptismal naming with Father and Son, placed at the same grammatical level, not as a lesser fourth term.

1Cor.12.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4151 πνεῦμα, G1014 βούλομαι

Force. "all these things one and the same Spirit works, apportioning to each one individually as he wills" (πάντα δὲ ταῦτα ἐνεργεῖ τὸ ἐν καὶ τὸ αὐτὸ πνεῦμα, διαιροῦν ἰδίᾳ ἐκάστῳ καθὼς βούλεται). The Spirit ("spirit," πνεῦμα) is the explicit subject of "wills" (βούλεται, parsed V-PNI-3S, present indicative, an ongoing simple statement of fact, meaning to will or decide). Willing and apportioning at one's own discretion are acts of a personal agent, telling against an impersonal-power reading of "spirit" (πνεῦμα).

Eph.4.30 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3076 λυπέω, G4151 πνεῦμα, G2316 θεός

Force. "do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God" (μὴ λυπεῖτε τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον τοῦ θεοῦ). The Spirit ("spirit," πνεῦμα) is the object of "do not grieve" (λυπεῖτε, parsed V-PAM-2P, meaning to grieve), and the genitive ("of-X" form) "of God" (τοῦ θεοῦ) ties the Spirit to God. To be grieved is an affective response proper to a person, again resisting an impersonal-force reading.

Acts.13.2 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G4151 πνεῦμα, G0040 ἅγιος

Force. "the Holy Spirit said, Set apart for me Barnabas and Saul" (εἶπεν τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον, Ἀφορίσατε δὴ μοι τὸν Βαρναβᾶν καὶ Σαῦλον). The Spirit ("spirit," πνεῦμα) is the subject of "said" (εἶπεν, meaning to say) and speaks in the first person, "for me" (μοι), set apart for ME, claiming the missionaries as the Spirit's own. First-person speech and self-reference are personal acts.

John.16.13 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1565 ἐκεῖνος, G4151 πνεῦμα

Force. "when he comes, the Spirit of truth" (ὅταν δὲ ἔλθῃ ἐκεῖνος, τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας). Morphology confirms "that one, he" (ἐκεῖνος) is masculine nominative (subject form) singular (parsed D-NSM) while its antecedent "the spirit" (τὸ πνεῦμα) is neuter (parsed N-NSN). The deliberate masculine pronoun over a grammatically neuter noun signals a personal referent, not a thing, and the Spirit then performs personal verbs, will guide, will speak, will declare.

2Cor.3.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2962 κύριος, G4151 πνεῦμα

Force. "now the Lord is the Spirit" (ὁ δὲ κύριος τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν). The copula (the linking verb "is") "is" (ἐστιν, parsed V-PAI-3S, present indicative, an ongoing simple statement of fact) links "Lord" (κύριος) and "the Spirit" (τὸ πνεῦμα). Whatever the precise scope of the predication (the descriptive statement), the verse places the Spirit on the "Lord" (κύριος) side of the divine ledger rather than the creature side. The following clause speaks of "the Spirit of the Lord" (τὸ πνεῦμα κυρίου), the Spirit of the Lord, reinforcing the divine association.

Heb.9.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4151 πνεῦμα, G0166 αἰώνιος

Force. "through the eternal Spirit" (διὰ πνεύματος αἰωνίου). The Spirit ("spirit," πνεῦμα) is qualified by "eternal" (αἰωνίου, parsed A-GSN, an attribute meaning eternal), an attribute the canon reserves for God and divine realities. Eternity predicated of the Spirit supplies the co-eternal element of the proposition at the word level, since a creature is not termed eternal in this sense.

Ps.139.7 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H7307 הנה

Force. "Where can I go from your Spirit, and where can I flee from your presence?" (אַלְךָ מִרוּחְךָ וְאֵנָּה מִפְּנֵיךָ אֶבְרַח). Where can I go from your spirit ("spirit," ruach), and where can I flee from your face. Hebrew morphology confirms "spirit" (ruach, Strong's H7307) in parallel with "your face, your presence" (paneka). The Spirit is here coextensive with God's inescapable presence, an Old Testament attestation of divine omnipresence (being everywhere at once) predicated of the Spirit, which anchors the proposition outside the New Testament.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Acts.5.4	Acts.5.3	tsk	1
Acts.5.3	Acts.5.9	tsk	1
Acts.5.4	Acts.8.21	tsk	1
1Cor.3.16	Ezek.36.27	tsk	1
Matt.28.19	Matt.3.16	tsk	1
2Cor.13.14	Num.6.23	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Acts.5.9 · addressed

Acts 5:9 names the same offense "to test the Spirit of the Lord" (πειράσαι τὸ πνεῦμα κυρίου), testing the Spirit of the Lord. The genitive ("of-X" form) "of the Lord" (κυρίου) chains the Spirit to the divine title, so the third predication (third descriptive statement) of one event reinforces rather than complicates the identification across verses 3, 4, and 9.

1Cor.6.19 · addressed

1 Corinthians 6:19 calls the body "the temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you" (ναὸς τοῦ ἐν ὑμῖν ἁγίου πνεύματος), the temple of the Holy Spirit, parallel to 1 Corinthians 3:16 where the same indwelt locus is "temple of God" (ναὸς θεοῦ). Two temple predications (two descriptive statements about the temple) of one referent equate Spirit and God in the temple-presence category.

John.3.8 · addressed

John 3:8 plays on "spirit/wind" (πνεῦμα) in its impersonal sense, the wind blows where it wills, which shows the word can denote breath or wind. This is the lexical foothold for an impersonal-force reading. It does not overturn the verdict because the contested verses supply personal verbs (wills, is grieved, speaks, is lied to) and a masculine pronoun for the neuter noun (John 16:13), which an impersonal sense cannot carry. Context disambiguates the polysemy (multiple possible meanings) in each anchor.

2Cor.3.17 · addressed

The copula (linking verb "is") in "the Lord is the Spirit" (ὁ κύριος τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν) is read by some as functional identification (the Lord experienced now is the Spirit) rather than ontological identity (an identity in actual being), so this verse alone does not settle full deity. It is retained because it still places the Spirit on the divine side and is corroborated by the stronger God-equation in Acts 5:3-4. Treated as supporting, not load-bearing.

Concordance traversed

G4151, G2316, G0040, G2962, G5574, G3485, G3611, G3686, G1014, G3076, G0166, G1565, G3962, G5207, G0907, H7307, H1272

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

Direct query of the lexical store returns zero VariantUnit nodes (manuscript-variant records) attached to Acts 5:3, Acts 5:4, 1 Corinthians 3:16, or Matthew 28:19. None of these anchors falls in the ingested ECM (critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window (3 John 1:1 to 1:15), so they are not_in_ecm_scope. The trinitarian baptismal command at Matthew 28:19 is textually stable in all extant Greek manuscripts. No variant reading at any anchor disturbs the Spirit-God predication (the grammatical equation that the Spirit is God).

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

impersonal_force_reading: incompatible · Strongest form: "spirit" (πνεῦμα) is grammatically neuter and lexically denotes breath or wind (so John 3:8), so the Holy Spirit could be read as God's active power or influence rather than a person. The data resists this. The Spirit wills ("wills," βούλεται, 1 Corinthians 12:11), is grieved ("do not grieve," λυπεῖτε, Ephesians 4:30), speaks in the first person (Acts 13:2), and is the object of a lie (Acts 5:3). John 16:13 even takes the masculine "that one, he" (ἐκεῖνος) for the neuter "the spirit" (τὸ πνεῦμα). Personal predicates (descriptive statements that only fit a person) are not predicable of an impersonal force.

subordinationist_reading: incompatible · Strongest form: the Spirit could be a created or lesser divine agent, not co-equal God. The lexical equations block this. Lying to the Spirit is lying to God (Acts 5:3-4), the Spirit-indwelt body is God's temple (1 Corinthians 3:16 with 6:19), the Spirit shares the single divine "name" (ὄνομα) (Matthew 28:19), is called eternal (Hebrews 9:14), and is omnipresent (everywhere at once, Psalm 139:7). Divine attributes and the God-equation are not predicable of a creature.

modalist_reading: incompatible · Strongest form: Father, Son, and Spirit could be one person in three successive modes. The grammar of distinction blocks this. Matthew 28:19 names three articular genitives (three "of-the-X" forms each carrying "the") under one "name" (ὄνομα) as distinct, the Spirit speaks of itself and of another (Acts 13:2, John 16:13-14, "he will glorify me," ἐκεῖνος ἐμὲ δοξάσει), and 2 Corinthians 13:14 distributes distinct relations to three named agents. The text requires distinction-in-unity (real distinction within one being), not one person in masks.

Two lexical lines converge: divine identity (the Acts 5 God-equation, the shared single "name" (ὄνομα), temple-presence, the eternity and omnipresence attributes) and personhood (the personal verbs and the masculine pronoun "that one, he" (ἐκεῖνος) for the neuter noun "the spirit" (τὸ πνεῦμα)). Each answers a distinct denial, the subordinationist (lesser-God) or modalist (one-person-in-modes) on deity and the impersonal-force

reading on personhood.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem (the question's wording) uses descriptive predicates (fully and truly God, co-equal, co-eternal) without importing a tradition-specific taxonomy (a labeling system tied to one tradition). The lexical question is twofold and tested on the original stem: does the canon predicate (assert as a descriptive statement) of the Spirit what it predicates of God (deity), and does it predicate personal acts of the Spirit (personhood). Both are answered from queried morphology and concordance. Verdict unchanged from the prior file.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Acts.5.3
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.16.13
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1Cor.12.11
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Matt.28.19
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.5.4
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Eph.4.30
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.9.14
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.7
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Acts.5.3-4
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4151
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1014
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H7307
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Acts.5.4
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Matt.28.19
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Cor.3.16

License audit

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Flags

(none)